

FreeBoard

User Manual

A practical guide to Google sign-in, profiles, connections, timetables, and schedule features.

Web App	https://freeboard-phi.vercel.app/
Backend API	https://free-board-ashen.vercel.app/
Authentication	Google Sign-In

Quick start: Open the web app, sign in with Google, complete setup if prompted, and start using your timetable and connections.

1. Getting Started

What is FreeBoard?

FreeBoard is a student-focused web application for managing a profile, connecting with other users, saving timetable information, and using schedule-related features.

Open FreeBoard

Visit <https://freeboard-phi.vercel.app/> in a modern browser.

Before you begin

Have access to the Google account you want to use, keep browser cookies enabled, and use a stable internet connection.

2. Google Sign-In and First-Time Setup

Step 1 — Start sign-in

Open FreeBoard, select Google sign-in, choose your Google account, and complete Google's authentication flow.

Step 2 — Return to FreeBoard

After successful authentication, FreeBoard creates an application session and redirects you to the app.

Step 3 — First-time setup

If this is your first login, the app may open in setup mode so you can claim or configure your username.

Tip: If the issue persists, record the exact error before changing configuration.

3. Your Profile

Username

Your username is the account identifier used inside FreeBoard. Choose it during first-time setup.

Display name

Your display name is the friendly name shown to other users and can be updated through the profile controls.

Avatar

When available from your Google profile, your Google profile picture can be associated with your FreeBoard account.

4. Connections and User Search

Search

Use user search to find another FreeBoard user and initiate a connection request.

Requests

FreeBoard supports connection requests. Incoming requests can be accepted or declined.

Manage connections

View connections, remove a connection when needed, and optionally set a nickname for a connection.

Typical workflow

Search → send request → wait for acceptance → view connection → optionally set a nickname.

Tip: If the issue persists, record the exact error before changing configuration.

5. Timetable

View

Open the timetable area and select the relevant user when the interface provides that option. FreeBoard retrieves timetable information.

Save

After editing timetable cells, use the save action. Changes are submitted and stored for later retrieval.

Accuracy tips

Keep day and period information consistent and review changes before saving.

6. Live / Together Schedule Features

Live schedule

Checks schedule information for a selected day and timetable slot/period.

Together

Compares schedules for multiple users and can help connected students find periods that line up.

Practical use

Keep your timetable saved and use schedule features to check the selected period and compare schedules with other users.

7. Logging Out

Log out

Use the application's Logout control to end your FreeBoard session. The session is cleared and you return to the sign-in page.

Shared devices

Always log out when you finish using FreeBoard on a shared computer.

8. Troubleshooting

Google sign-in returns to the login page

Refresh and try again. Make sure cookies are enabled. You can also try a private/incognito window or another browser.

A feature does not work

Refresh and retry. Note the page, action, and visible error message if the problem continues.

Backend health check

Visit <https://free-board-ashen.vercel.app/health>. A successful response is `{"status":"ok"}`.

Changes are not visible

Hard-refresh with **Ctrl + Shift + R**. If a deployment was just made, wait until the latest Vercel deployment is Ready.

Tip: If the issue persists, record the exact error before changing configuration.

9. Good Practices

- Keep your timetable up to date.
- Use a recognizable display name or nickname.
- Log out on shared devices.
- Do not share private credentials or session information.
- When reporting a problem, include the page, action, expected result, actual result, browser, and error message.

[End of FreeBoard User Manual](#)